ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

REPORT ON LOCAL AUTHORITY BY-ELECTIONS HELD ON THE 26TH OF JULY 2025



Ward 10 Chikomba RDC

Ward 4 Chiredzi RDC

Ward 10 and 14 Gutu RDC

Ward 6 Marondera RDC

Ward 19 Mazowe RDC

Executive Summary

1. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.
2. Its functions are provided for in *Section 239* of the said Constitution.
3. The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission published a Vacancy Notice on 12 May 2025 calling for the conduct of local authority by-elections which were necessitated either by the death, resignation or recall of sitting councillors.
4. Councillors Gombera Manyika, Reza Amos and Mutauri Nelson of Ward 10 Chikomba Rural District Council (RDC), Ward 6 of Marondera RDC and Ward 19 of Mazowe RDC died on 21, 27 and 24 May 2025 respectively. Councillors Mashulani Robson and Mudonhi Jairos representing Ward 4 of Chiredzi RDC and Ward of 10 Gutu RDC respectively ceased to be members of their sponsoring party, ZANU PF, on 19 May 2025. Councillor Masvingise Zvarevashe who represented Ward 14 of Gutu RDC resigned on 1 May 2025. The by-elections to fill the said vacancies were held on the 26th of July 2025.
5. The Commission made a combined request of ZWG 22,393,098 for the by-elections but Treasury only released ZIG 12,000,000.
6. The Commission conducted voter education exercises for the pre-nomination and pre-polling phases. The pre-nomination voter education messages focused on the causes of the by-election, and the required qualifications of aspiring candidates while the pre-polling messages were on how to vote.
7. The Nomination Courts to receive nomination papers from aspiring candidates to stand for election as Councillors in the wards mentioned above sat on 26 June 2025.
8. The candidates listed in Schedule 1 below were duly nominated for election as councillors while those in Schedule 2 were duly elected as councillors of the wards in their respective local authorities unopposed as no other nomination papers were received at the close of sitting of the Nomination Courts.

SCHEDULE 1

Contested Wards

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Chikomba RDC	10	Muchenje Tawanda	M	Independent
		Mukandi Tafadzwa	M	ZANU PF
Chiredzi RDC	4	Jekero David	M	Independent
		Luhinga Hasani	M	Independent
		Macheke Joseph	M	Independent
		Phikelele Austin	M	ZANU PF
Marondera RDC	6	Tongawashe Fiona	F	ZANU PF
		Ziyanga Richard	M	Independent

SCHEDULE 2

Uncontested Wards

Local Authority	Ward	Names	Sex	Party
Gutu RDC	10	Muzire Fibion	M	ZANU PF
Gutu RDC	14	Mudadi Katinos	M	ZANU PF
Mazowe RDC	19	Muskwe Tichaona	M	ZANU PF

9. Independent candidates Jekero David and Luhinga Hasani later withdrew their candidatures from Ward 4 of Chiredzi RDC. The withdrawal left Macheke Joseph, an Independent candidate to contest with Phikelele Austin of ZANU PF party.
10. A total of ten thousand six hundred (10 600) ballot papers were printed for the local authority by-elections. This information was publicised in terms of the law.
11. The Commission established seventeen (17) polling stations for voting purposes which were publicized in terms of the law.
12. The Commission used its own fleet of vehicles for the by-elections.
13. The training of electoral officers for different categories was conducted between 16 June and 24 July 2025. Each polling station was staffed with seven (7) Polling Officers

including the Presiding Officer. Applications for the accreditation of observers were received and processed on time.

14. Applications for the accreditation of observers were received and processed on time.

15. Polling took place on 26 July 2025 and results were announced on the same day.

16. The following candidates were declared duly elected after the conduct of poll: -

	Local Authority	**Ward**	**Candidate**	**Sex**	**Sponsoring Party**
1	Chikomba RDC	10	Mukandi Tafadzwa	M	ZANU PF
2	Chiredzi RDC	4	Phikelele Austin	M	ZANU PF
3	Marondera RDC	6	Tongawashe Fiona	F	ZANU PF

17. The 26th of July 2025 by-elections were conducted in a calm and peaceful environment.

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CHAPTER I: THE ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION

1.1 Composition

The Zimbabwe Electoral Commission (ZEC) is an Election Management Body (EMB) established in terms of the Section 238 of the Constitution of Zimbabwe.

It is composed of the Chairperson appointed by the President after consultation with the Judicial Service Commission and the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders and eight other members appointed by the President from a list of not fewer than twelve nominees submitted by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

At the time of the by-elections, the Commission consisted of a full board of nine members as follows:

1. Honourable Mrs Justice Priscilla Chigumba - Chairperson
2. Ambassador Rodney Kiwa - Deputy Chairperson
3. Mrs Abigail Millicent Mohadi Ambrose - Commissioner
4. Mr Shepherd Manhivi - Commissioner
5. Ms Catherine Mpofu - Commissioner
6. Mrs Rosewita Murutare - Commissioner
7. Mr Jasper Mangwana - Commissioner
8. Dr Janet Mbetu Nzvenga - Commissioner
9. Dr Kudzai Shava - Commissioner

1.2 Functions of the Commission

The functions of the Zimbabwe Electoral Commission are provided for in Section 239 of the Constitution as follows:

a. to prepare for, conduct and supervise –

   (i) elections to the office of President and to Parliament;

   (ii) elections to provincial and metropolitan councils and the governing bodies of local authorities;

   (iii) elections of members of the National Council of Chiefs established by section 285; and

   (iv) referendums;

   and to ensure that those elections and referendums are conducted efficiently, freely, fairly, transparently and in accordance with the law,

b. to supervise elections of the President of the Senate and the Speaker and to ensure that these elections are conducted efficiently and in accordance with the law;

c. to register voters;

d. to compile voters' rolls and registers,

e. to ensure the proper custody and maintenance of voters rolls and registers;

f. to delimit constituencies, wards and other electoral boundaries;

g. to design, print and distribute ballot papers, approve the form of and procure ballot boxes, and establish and operate polling centres;

h. to conduct and supervise voter education;

i. to accredit observers of elections and referendums;

j. to give instructions to persons in the employment of the State or of a local authority for the purpose of ensuring the efficient, free, fair, proper and transparent conduct of any election or referendum; and

k. to receive and consider complaints from the public and to take such action in regard to the complaints as it considers appropriate.

1.3 Additional Functions

The Electoral Act [*Chapter 2:13*] in Section 5 thereof provides for additional functions and powers of the Commission as follows:

a) undertaking and promoting research into electoral matters

b) developing expertise and the use of technology in regard to the electoral processes; and

c) promoting co-operation between Government, political parties and civil society in regard to elections; and

d) keeping the public informed about -

   i. the times and places where persons can register as voters and the progress of the voter registration exercise; and

   ii. the delimitation of wards, constituencies and other electoral boundaries, and

   iii. the location and boundaries of polling stations and when they are open for inspection; and

   iv. voters' rolls and the times and places at which they are open for inspection; and

   v. political parties and candidates contesting every election and;

   vi. voting; and

   vii. generally, all matters relating to the Commission's work and the electoral process; and

d1) ensuring that gender is mainstreamed into electoral processes; and

e) making recommendations to Parliament on appropriate ways to provide public financing for political parties.

CHAPTER II

PREPARATIONS FOR THE BY-ELECTIONS

The Commission issued a ZEC Notice on 12 June 2025 calling for the conduct of local authority by-elections following the resignation, recalls and death of sitting councillors in some local authorities.

Councillors Gombera Manyika, Reza Amos and Mutauri Nelson of Wards 10 Chikomba Rural District Council (RDC), 19 of Mazowe RDC and 6 of Marondera RDC died on 21, 24 and 27 May 2025 respectively. Councillors Mashulani Robson and Mudonhi Jairos representing Wards 4 of Chiredzi RDC and 10 of Gutu RDC respectively ceased to be members of their sponsoring party, ZANU PF, on 19 May 2025. Councillor Masvingise Zvarevashe who represented Ward 14 of Gutu RDC resigned on 1 May 2025. The conduct of the said by-elections was harmonised and same were held on the 26th of July 2025.

2.1 Voter Education

The Commission conducted pre-nomination and pre-polling voter education for the said by-elections during the periods 18 June to 22 June and 17 to 21July 2025 respectively. The key messages for the pre-nomination centred on sensitizing the electorate on the existence of vacancies, the requirements for nomination of candidates and the boundaries of the wards. The pre-polling voter education emphasised on preparing the electorate on the contesting candidates, correct documentation to carry, the polling date and times, polling station specific voting, the voting process and how to cast a vote and encouraging the electorate to go and vote.

The voter education teams used various methodologies to educate the electorate such as the door-to-door visits, interaction with individuals and addressing of gatherings, use of posters, distribution of pamphlets and flyers and use of hailers.

2.2 Nomination Courts

The Nomination Courts to receive papers from aspiring candidates sat on 26 June 2025.
The following candidates were nominated for election at the close of the sitting of the Nomination Courts:

Persons Nominated for Election

Local Authority	Ward	Candidate	Sex	Sponsoring Party
Chikomba RDC	10	Muchenje Tawanda	M	Independent
		Mukandi Tafadzwa	M	ZANU PF
Chiredzi RDC	4	Jekero David	M	Independent
		Luhinga Hasani	M	Independent
		Macheke Joseph	M	Independent
		Phikelele Austin	M	ZANU PF
Marondera RDC	6	Tongawashe Fiona	F	ZANU PF
		Ziyanga Richard	M	Independent

The following candidates were declared duly elected unopposed after the closure of the sitting of the Nomination Courts as no other candidates filed papers for the respective wards.

Local Authority	Ward	Names	Sex	Party
Gutu RDC	10	Muzire Fibion	M	ZANU PF
Gutu RDC	14	Mudadi Katinos	M	ZANU PF
Mazowe RDC	19	Muskwe Tichaona	M	ZANU PF

Polling took place on ***Saturday, 26 July 2025*** in the following Wards 4, 6 and 10 of Chiredzi, Maraondera and Chikomba RDCs respectively.

2.3 Provision of voters rolls to Candidates

The Commission provided the candidates with electronic copies of the voters' roll for all the wards. The polling stations and Ward Command Centres were each furnished with a copy of the voters roll for use on polling day as well as another copy (without pictures) for display two days before poll day for voters to check their names.

2.4 Withdrawal of Candidature

Two candidates from Ward 4 of Chiredzi RDC withdrew their candidature. Jekero David withdrew on the 3rd of July 2025 and Luhinga Hasani on the 4th of July 2025. Letters of

withdrawal were received at Head office and notices of withdrawals were published in accordance with the law.

2.5 Multiparty Liaison Committee Meetings

Wards 10 of Chikomba RDC and 4 of Chiredzi RDC candidates and stakeholders held two (2) multiparty liaison committee meetings each while Ward 6 of Marondera RDC had only one (1). The meetings were successful and a high level of political tolerance was exhibited as stakeholders resolved issues without challenges.

2.6 Polling Stations

The Commission established seventeen (17) polling stations broken down as follows:

Local Authority	Ward	No of polling Stations
Chikomba RDC	10	4
Chiredzi RDC	4	6
Marondera RDC	6	7

2.7 Ballot Paper Printing

A total of ten thousand six hundred ballots papers (10 600) were printed for the 26 July 2025 by-elections and were distributed as follows:

Local Authority	Ward	Ballot Papers Printed
Chikomba RDC	10	2500
Chiredzi RDC	4	4850
Marondera RDC	6	3250

The Printing and Minting Company of Zimbabwe printed the ballot papers. This information was published in compliance with the law.

2.8 Transport and Fuel

The Commission used its fleet of vehicles for all the by-elections. Both provinces had adequate motor vehicles and fuel to cover all the requirements of the by-election.

2.9 Recruitment, Training and Deployment of Electoral Officers

Personnel to conduct the by-elections were drawn mainly from the ZEC Secretariat, the Public Service Commission and the respective Local Authorities.

2.10 Accreditation of Observers and Media Personnel

The accreditation of observers and media started after the publication of the ZEC Notice.

There were no local observers for the by-elections. Only sixty-three (63) ZEC officials were accredited.

CHAPTER III

CONDUCT OF ELECTION – POLLING

3.1 Polling

Polling took place on 26 July 2025 commencing at 0700 hours and ending at 1900 hours. Due regard was given to the provision that no voter in the queue waiting to vote at 1900 hours would be turned away. Every polling station was staffed with electoral officers based on its voter population threshold.

In addition to the electoral officers, there were candidates and election agents. Police officers provided security and performed other duties as provided for in the law. Only one (1) distinctly marked ballot box was set up at each polling station.

3.2 Results of polls

The summary of the results for the by-election was as follows:

Local Authority	Ward	Candidates	Sex	Party	Votes	
Chikomba RDC	10	Muchenje Tawanda	M	Independent	290	
		Mukandi Tafadzwa	*M*	*ZANU PF*	*447*	*Winner*
		Total Valid Votes Cast			**737**	
		Total Votes Rejected			**9**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**746**	
		Voter Population			**2357**	
		Percentage Poll			**31,7%**	

Local Authority	Ward	Candidates	Sex	Party	Votes	
Chiredzi RDC	4	Macheke Joseph	M	Independent	***265***	
		Phikelele Austin	*M*	*ZANU PF*	*1577*	*Winner*
		Total Valid Votes Cast			**1842**	
		Total Votes Rejected			**67**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**1909**	
		Voter Population			**4548**	
		Percentage Poll			**42,0%**	

Local Authority	**Ward**	**Candidates**	**Sex**	**Party**	**Votes**	
Maronderai RDC	6	*Tongawashe Fiona*	*F*	*ZANU PF*	*928*	*Winner*
		Ziyanga Richard	M	Independent	22	
		Total Valid Votes Cast			950	
		Total Votes Rejected			**28**	
		Ballot Paper Unaccounted for			**0**	
		Total Votes Cast			**978**	
		Voter Population			**3022**	
		Percentage Poll			**32,4%**	

3.3 The Environment

The political environment was calm. There were no reported cases of politically motivated incidents before, during and after the by-elections.

CHAPTER IV

BUDGET

4.0 Budget

For the 26 July 2025 by-elections, the Commission received, ZWG12 000 000 from Treasury following a request of ZWG 22 393 098.

4.1 Budget Control

The Commission applied all financial statutory guidelines in line with the law.

Chapter V

OBSERVATIONS, RECOMMENDATIONS AND CONCLUSION

The Commission made a number of observations and recommendations as presented below:

5.0 Budget

Observation

There is a notable difference between the budgetary requirements requested and the amounts released by Treasury.

Recommendation

There is need to bridge the gap between what the Commission requests and what Treasury allocates and releases so as to meet all the budgetary requirements. Timeous funding is also critical in the implementation of polling processes.

5.1 Payment of Allowances in Local Currency

Observation

The payment of advance allowances was well appreciated and cushioned staff. The notable observation was that it being paid in local currency while many local shops trade in foreign currencies with their exchange rates higher than the official exchange rate, that scenario affected the local currency's purchasing power especially in Masvingo Province (Chiredzi).

Recommendation

There is need for partial payment of allowances in foreign currency to cushion electoral officers.

5.2 Aging Fleet of Motor Vehicles

Observation

Some of the ZEC vehicles procured during the 2018 and 2023 General Elections constantly broke down.

5.3 Need for All Terrain Vehicles

Observation

Most of the election related activities happen in areas with unnavigable roads. The roads require all terrain kind of motor vehicles.

Recommendation

The Commission recommends that it be prioritised on the procurement of additional fleet of all terrain motor vehicles

5.4 Conclusion

The Commission discharged its constitutional mandate in a transparent and professional manner. It consulted and worked in collaboration with its stakeholders throughout the election period ensuring that the process was inclusive, transparent and peaceful. The 26 July 2025 by-elections were conducted in a manner and under conditions that allowed voters to freely express their will.

Signed:  Date: ……....

Mrs Justice Priscilla Makanyara Chigumba

ZEC Chairperson



ZIMBABWE ELECTORAL COMMISSION